



PTH 8235: Patient / Client Management V

Department of Physical Therapy

Spring 2026

Course Information:

Semester: Spring

Credit Hours: 6

Weekly Clock Hours:	Lecture: 2	Lab: 5	Other: 1
Semester Clock Hours:	Lecture: 30	Lab: 75	Other: 10

Course Instructors:

Coordinator and Lymphatic & Wound Module Instructor:

Barbara Crane, PT, PhD Contact: bacrane1@plymouth.edu

Office Hours: Tuesdays/Thursdays 4-5; Wednesday 12:30 – 2:30 or by appointment

Cardiopulmonary Module Instructor:

Andrew Plese, PT, DPT

Contact: email ajp1151@usnh.edu phone: 214-704-7283

Office Hours: by appointment

Lab Instructor: Tracey Houle, PT, DPT

Contact: tvhoule@plymouth.edu

Office Hours: Friday 2-3 pm or by appointment

Lab Instructor: Tim Duffy, PT, DPT, OCS

Contact: tduffy1@plymouth.edu

Office Hours: Friday 2-3 pm or by appointment

Pre Requisites: Clinical Education I, Clinical Reflection I, Clinical Inquiry II, Patient / Client Management IV, Integrated Clinical IV

Co Requisites: Clinical Inquiry II, Psychosocial Systems, Integrated Clinical V

Course Description

Patient / Client Management V is a problem-based course with tutorial and laboratory sessions and continues to develop depth and problem solving. This course specifically adds evaluation and interventions for body system specific pathologies, screening for medical referral and ICU / complex medical issues and complications.

Student Learning Outcomes:

1. Implements appropriate teaching methods commensurate with the needs of the learner.
2. Explain screening and the many factors that contribute to determining whether patients/clients need further examination or consultation by a physical therapist or referral to another health care professional.
3. Identify and refer clients who might benefit from services or from consultation with other professionals for management of issues related to a diagnosis and be able to effectively explain reasons for and benefits of services (including genetic services).
4. Obtain a history and relevant information from the patient/client and from other sources as needed including a genetic family history with a minimum three generation history.
5. Perform a systems review. Including the cardiovascular/pulmonary system through the assessment of blood pressure, heart rate, respiration rate, and edema; the integumentary system through the gross assessment of skin color, turgor, integrity, and the presence of wounds, burns or scars.
6. Select and perform physical therapy tests and measures and factors that influence their use based on patients age; diagnosis and health status to assess patients / clients with complex medical issues and complications, including Aerobic Capacity/Endurance, Circulation (Arterial; Venous; Lymphatic), Ventilation and Respiration or Gas Exchange a variable clinical practice condition.
7. Evaluate data from the examination (history; health record; systems review; and tests and measures) to make clinical judgments.
8. Identify components and their interactions of the International Classification of Function (ICF) to describe a patient's/clients impairments; activity and participation limitations.
9. Determine a diagnosis that guides future patient/client management.
10. Determine patient/client goals and expected outcomes within available resources (including applicable payment sources) and specify expected length of time to achieve the goals and outcomes.
11. Establish a safe and effective plan of care that is developed in collaboration with appropriate stakeholders; including patients/clients; family members; payors; other professionals and other appropriate individuals.
12. Explain those components of the plan of care that may; or may not; be directed to the physical therapist assistant (PTA) based on (a) the needs of the patient/client; (b) the role; education; and training of the PTA; (c) competence of the individual PTA; (d) jurisdictional law; (e) practice guidelines policies; and (f) facility policies.
13. Explain factors that lead to a discontinuation of episode of care plan that optimizes success for the patient in moving along the continuum of care.
14. Select and perform physical therapy interventions to achieve patient/client goals and outcomes with complex medical issues and complications. Interventions include: Airway Clearance Techniques, Biophysical Agents, Functional Training in Self-Care and in Domestic, Integumentary Repair and Protection Manual Therapy Techniques (including

mobilization/manipulation thrust and non-thrust techniques), Patient/Client education, Therapeutic Exercise in complex cases and variable clinical practice environments.

15. Explain what is necessary to manage the delivery of the plan of care that is consistent with professional obligations; inter professional collaborations; and administrative policies and procedures of the practice environment.
16. Delineate, communicate and supervise those areas of the plan of care that will be directed to the PTA.
17. Explain the process of monitoring and adjusting the plan of care in response to patient/client status.
18. Explain factors used to assess patient outcomes; including the use of appropriate standardized tests and measures that address impairments; functional status and participation.
19. Complete accurate documentation that follows guidelines and specific documentation formats required by state practice acts; the practice setting; and other regulatory agencies for patients with complex and varied medical conditions.
20. Describe the necessary considerations and training for responding effectively to patient/client and environmental emergencies in ones practice setting.
21. Describe the provision of physical therapy services that address primary; secondary and tertiary prevention; health promotion; and wellness to individuals; groups; and communities.
22. Describe the case management process.
23. Assess and document safety risks of patients and the healthcare provider and design and implement strategies to improve safety in the healthcare setting as an individual and as a member of the interprofessional healthcare team.
24. Develop a treatment plan for a patient with a wound based on knowledge and understanding of the integumentary system and wound healing process.
25. Perform a differential diagnosis for a patient with edema based on understanding of the circulatory and lymphatic systems and relevant system interactions as well as a patient history of conditions contributing to the development of edema.

Textbook, required readings, materials and other learning resources

Access Physiotherapy resources will be identified for the topics in this course.

Additional readings will also be provided as appropriate.

Description of teaching methods and learning experiences

Tutorial sessions, videos and guided learning activities, laboratory, group discussions, case presentations, hands on lab activities

Cases

Throughout the semester students will be presented with both Macro and Micro cases and will prepare responses to questions and problems prior to participating in class discussion. The case problem sets in PCM V specifically focuses on evaluation and interventions for body system specific pathologies, screening for medical referral and ICU / complex medical issues and complications.

Practical Skills Examination

Practical skills examination grades are incorporated into the PCM course grades (as indicated under “assessment” below). An aggregate grade of less than 73% results in automatic failure of this PCM course. There are elements to a practical examination grade that are considered safety concerns and failure in any element related to a safety concern can result in immediate failure of the practical exam.

If a student fails the practical examination they can repeat one time and achieve a maximal grade of 73%.

Prior to the repeat practical examination the student must meet with the PCM course coordinator to review the results, develop a remediation plan and make plans for the repeat examination. The repeat practical examination will be a subset of the original examination, including only the elements that clearly led to failure.

Assessment:

Mid Term Exam: 35%

Cumulative Final Exam: 45%

Rounds Presentations: 5%

Practical Skills Examination: 15%

Student Evaluation/Grading

A	94.0 – 100
A-	90.0 – 93.9
B+	87.0 – 89.9
B	83.0 – 86.9
B-	80.0 – 82.9
C+	77.0 – 79.9
C	73.0 – 76.9
F	below 73.0

Students are reminded that continuation in the program necessitates achieving an overall grade point average of 3.0 (B) or better. Grades below 2.0 (C) are not acceptable or counted toward the DPT degree. No more than 10 credits below 3.0 may be counted toward the DPT degree (grades of B-, C+, or C). Make-up examinations will be given only in specific cases of absence (documented absences). Circumstances that may warrant an absence should be discussed with the instructor before the scheduled time of the exam. Failure to notify the instructor as stated may result in a zero for the exam.

Professional Conduct: Students are reminded of the program expectation that they follow Professional Conduct, see the Student Handbook, Professional Conduct and Reasonable Professional Expectations for the process of handling violations, remediation and

consequences.

Cell Phones: Cell phone use (including texting) is prohibited in class. Also, please respect your classmates by turning your phone to vibrate prior to class start time. Do not turn phones off as the University uses texts to relate emergency information.

Graduate Academic Policies: The DPT Program is a selective admissions cohort-structured program. Some Graduate Academic Policies may not be relevant to the program. Students should refer to the Doctor of Physical Therapy Program Handbook for specific information about Scheduling, Capstones, and Internships. The sections on Grading System and Academic Standing Policy do apply to DPT students:

<https://coursecatalog.plymouth.edu/university-policies-procedures/graduate-academic-policies/>

Fair Grading Policy: Fair and equitable grading reflects values to which all members of the Plymouth State community commit themselves. Grades are used to assess the relative extent to which students achieve course objectives in all for-credit courses at PSU. Academic freedom allows instructors to determine course objectives within the bounds of established curricula, and the means by which a student's mastery of those objectives will be evaluated; and evaluate the quality of work on individual exams or assignments. Information can be found at <https://coursecatalog.plymouth.edu/university-policies-procedures/> under "Fair Grading".

Student Support: Student Support Foundation (SSF) provides short-term emergency financial assistance and long-term student support. For more information, see:

<https://campus.plymouth.edu/student-support-foundation/>

Student Support Foundation also runs a food pantry, located in Belknap Hall. To learn more about SSF or access the food pantry, either via open hours or a private appointment, contact the SSF advisor, at psu-ssf@plymouth.edu.

Academic Dishonesty: Cheating and plagiarism are very serious forms of academic dishonesty. Any use of unauthorized assistance on exams, papers, homework assignments, or other course work constitutes cheating. Knowingly providing assistance during an exam or allowing other students to copy one's work is also a serious form of academic dishonesty. Plagiarism consists of submitting written work that has been developed wholly or partially by someone else. Submitting written work in which the ideas of others have been duplicated or even paraphrased without proper reference to the author is also a form of plagiarism. Also considered plagiarism is the acquisition of term papers or other assignments from another source and subsequent presentation of these materials as the student's own work. In addition, students may not use papers in more than one course without the permission of both instructors.

Any student suspected of academic dishonesty will be reported to the Program Director immediately. A full description of academic integrity, violations and procedures when a violation to academic integrity in a course is suspected can be found at:

<https://coursecatalog.plymouth.edu/university-policies-procedures/> under Academic Integrity.

Attendance Policy: Attendance is expected to all class sessions. Students are ultimately responsible for their attendance, however faculty will assess students' Professional Expectations based, in part, on their attendance. Students who miss class for any reason are responsible for the information and work missed. Students should speak with the professor before missing the scheduled class when able.

Campus Accessibility Policy: Plymouth State University is committed to providing students with documented disabilities equal access to all university programs and facilities. If you think you have a disability requiring accommodations, you should immediately contact Campus Accessibility Services (CAS) in Speare 210 (535-3300) to determine whether you are eligible for such accommodations. Academic accommodations will only be considered for students who have registered with CAS. If you have a Letter of Accommodation for this course from CAS, please provide the instructor with that information privately so that you and the instructor can review those accommodations:

<https://campus.plymouth.edu/accessibility-services/>

LibGuide for Physical Therapy:

The Libguide for Physical Therapy is an information sharing platform created through a collaboration between the library and the DPT faculty that presents relevant resources to support students in the Physical Therapy program. Examples of information you will find include tutorials to better understand citing sources in APA and AMA style, resources on how to avoid plagiarism, quick access to relevant databases and interlibrary loan as well as a contact link to the programs' assigned librarian. To view the DPT Program Libguide go to <https://library.plymouth.edu/physical-therapy>.

Diversity and Inclusivity Statement:

We consider this classroom to be a place where you will be treated with respect, and we welcome individuals of all ages, backgrounds, beliefs, ethnicities, genders, gender identities, gender expressions, national origins, religious affiliations, sexual orientations, ability - and other visible and non-visible differences. All members of this class are expected to contribute to a respectful, welcoming and inclusive environment for every other member of the class. See this web page for the Plymouth State University IDEA Center Inclusion, Diversity, Equity, and Access. <https://www.plymouth.edu/idea-center>

Specific Outlines of Content:

Tuesday/Thursday Case Tutorial Session Schedule

Week	Macro Cases		Micro Cases	
	Tuesday	Thursday	Tuesday	Thursday
1 (Plese) Jan 20, 22	A1	A2		
2 (Plese) Jan 27, 29	A3	A4, B1	Micro 1	Micro 2
3 (Plese) Feb 3, 5	A5, B2	B3, C1	Micro 3	Micro 4
4 (Plese) Feb 10, 12	B4, C2	C3, D1	Micro 5	Micro 6
5 (Plese) Feb 17, 19	C4, D2	D3, E1	Micro 7	Micro 8
6 (Plese) Feb 24, 26	D4, E2	E3	Micro 9	Micro 10
7 (Plese) Mar 3, 5	Review / Summary	Midterm – In Person (Canvas)		
8 (Crane) Mar 10, 12	F1	F2	Micro 11,12	Micro 13,14
Spring Break Mar 17-21	Spring Break			
9 (Crane) Mar 24, 26	F3, G1	F4, G2	Micro 15	Micro 16
10 (Crane) Mar 31, Apr 2	G3, H1	G4, H2	Micro 17	Micro 18
11 (Crane) Apr 7, 9	H3, I1	H4, I2	Micro 19	Micro 20
12 (Crane) Apr 14, 16	I3, J1	I4, J2	Micro 21	Micro 22
13 (Crane) Apr 21, 23	J3, K1	J4, K2	Micro 23	Micro 24

14 (Crane) Apr 28, 30	K3; Exam Review	K4; Exam Review		
15 (Crane)	Final Exam – As Scheduled – In Person (Canvas)			

PCM 5 - Friday Lab Schedule 2026:

Friday Lab Rotations:

	8:00 – 9:00	9:15 – 11:15	11:30 – 1:30
Section 1	Rounds (instructors rotate)	A	B
Section 2	Rounds (instructors rotate)	B	A

Date	Rounds	Duffy (114 or 215)	Houle (215)	Crane (216)
Jan 23	8 – 9	(A) Circulation, Pulses, ABI	(B) RR, Rhythm, chest wall motion and breathing exercises	
Jan 30	8 – 9	(A) Blood Pressure, Auscultation	(B) Coughing mechanism, assisted and non-assisted cough strategies/ Bronchial Drainage positioning and Intro to Airway Clearance Manual Techniques	
Feb 6	8 – 9	(A) MIP/MEP/IMT	(B) Airway Clearance Manual Techniques & Clinical Application	
Feb 13			(A) Thoracic Mobility Exercises / Pediatrics Casework	(B) Wound Evaluation and Measurement
Feb 20	8 – 9	(A) NMES		(B) Wound debridement and treatments
Feb 27	8 – 9	(A) ECG, Respiration/orthostatic lab/dysautonomia lab		(B) Wound dressings
Mar 6	Nursing/PT Interprofessional Education (IPE) Day - times and schedule TBA (Plan for 8 am – 2:30 pm)			
Mar 13	8 - 9	(A) Breathing implications for LBP/Neck pain		(B) Wound Care – wrap up
Mar 20	Spring Break			
Mar 27	8 – 9	(A) TMD exam & eval and interventions		(B) Edema – examination/evaluation
April 3	8 – 9		(A) Neuro manual skills	(B) Edema - Treatment
April 10	8 – 9	(A) SIJ exam & eval and interventions	(B) Neuro Case Application / Acute Care, ICU Mobility	
April 17	8 – 9	(A) Cases / Practical Exam Review	(B) Cases / Practical Exam Review	
April 24	8 – 9			(A) Cases/ Practical Exam Review
May 1	Practical Skills Examination – Schedule TBA			